



OPPORTUNITY BRIEF

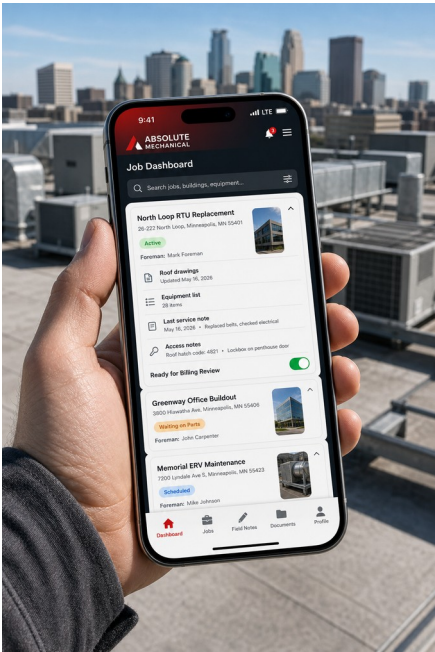
Build the visibility layer first

Prepared for Absolute Mechanical | Lawrence Tweed | June 3, 2026

1. Discovery	2. Opportunity	3. Pilot	4. Next step
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The clearest signal from discovery is that Absolute would benefit from a practical field operations portal: a way for the right person to pull up the current job, building, equipment, drawing, access note, field update, next action, or blocker without calling around.

That suggests a different starting point than a broad AI project to mine old records or automate processes. The first step should be a focused scoping effort: translate the operating knowledge now spread across ownership, office operations, and the field into clear requirements; identify the use cases that would matter most; and decide where AI can help clarify, prototype, or improve the system before a build path is chosen.



Illustrative mobile concept

RECOMMENDATION	REASON	NEXT DECISION
Scope a mobile-first field operations portal before pursuing broad AI analysis or automation.	The recurring pain is not missing information; it is that current context is scattered across systems, paper, and memory.	Decide whether to pressure-test the visibility-layer path before committing to any build, software, or AI-heavy project.

CORE IMPLICATION

The Client’s interest in a portal, visibility layer, or single pane of glass is the right first area to tackle. Scoping it will require Absolute to map how jobs move, where information lives, which handoffs create friction, and where tacit knowledge has become part of the operating system. That work can surface inefficiencies, duplication, and extra steps while also revealing where later GenAI analysis might mine bids, costs, service history, repairs, and equipment records for patterns that improve decisions and ROI.

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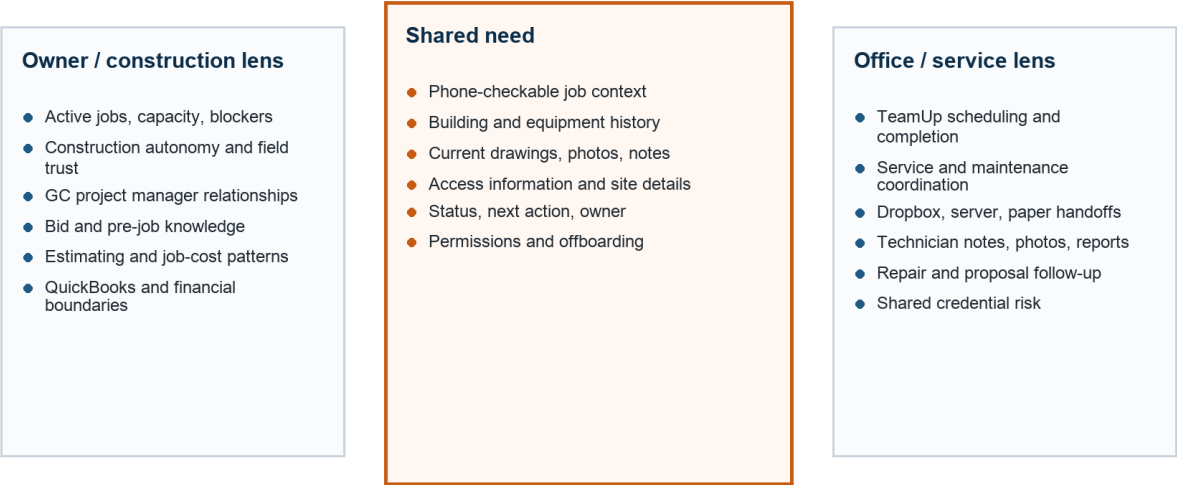
DISCOVERY SIGNALS

Different lenses, same visibility problem.

The responses surface two operating lenses that should both shape any build path. The owner/construction lens emphasizes active jobs, autonomy, capacity, blockers, GC relationships, and longer-term bid/job-cost value. The office/service lens emphasizes scheduling, preventive maintenance, repair follow-up, technician notes/photos, document access, completion status, and billing review. A useful visibility layer should clarify the shared current view while still respecting what each role actually needs to do.

Exhibit 1 | Two Operating Lenses, One Visibility Need

The discovery responses describe different parts of the same operating system.



Implication: build requirements should reflect both perspectives before choosing software, Microsoft tooling, or a custom build.

WHY THIS MATTERS

The discovery points to a business where useful information is already being created in the course of real work, but it lives across TeamUp, Dropbox, QuickBooks, server folders, paper files, emails, phones, and personal working knowledge. That is why the first opportunity is a visibility and workflow problem: give the office, field, and ownership a shared current view while preserving the flexibility construction work still requires.

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WORKFLOW REALITY

One job can touch many systems and handoffs before a clean current view exists.

The initial call and follow-up responses surfaced the representative workflows below. The exact sequences should be validated with the Absolute team, but the exercise is useful no matter which path is chosen: it shows how work moves across systems, people, and paper records; where inefficiencies or duplicated effort may exist; and what a portal would need to clarify before any build decision.

Exhibit 2 | Workflow Sequences and Touchpoints

Directional counts show how many handoffs and systems a job may touch before a clean current view exists.

Workflow	Representative sequence	Touchpoints
Service call	Phone/text/email → journal → Excel → QuickBooks → TeamUp → paper folder → assignment/call-text → technician → Dropbox/server context	7-9
Preventive maintenance	Excel list → monthly setup → journal → QuickBooks → paper folder → TeamUp → filter vendor → technician	8-9
Construction job	GC email/invite → walkthrough notes/sketch/Bluebeam → estimate/proposal → award → job number/journal/Excel → server folder → QuickBooks → paper folder → project manager/field	9-10
Repair follow-up	Diagnosis → parts quote request → vendor quote → office/Jake/Carrie → Word/PDF proposal → customer follow-up → approved repair → TeamUp → billing review	8-9
Bid / pre-job	GC invite/email → address/walkthrough/due date → PM notes/sketch/Bluebeam → proposal cycle to one or more GCs → award/loss/unknown	6+
Build implication: Identify the highest-friction handoffs, decide what the portal should show, what each source system remains responsible for, and who updates each field.		

The current process reflects a business that has grown around real work, field autonomy, paper habits, service urgency, customer relationships, and accounting controls. The opportunity is to preserve what works while reducing avoidable searching, duplicate entry, and handoff friction.

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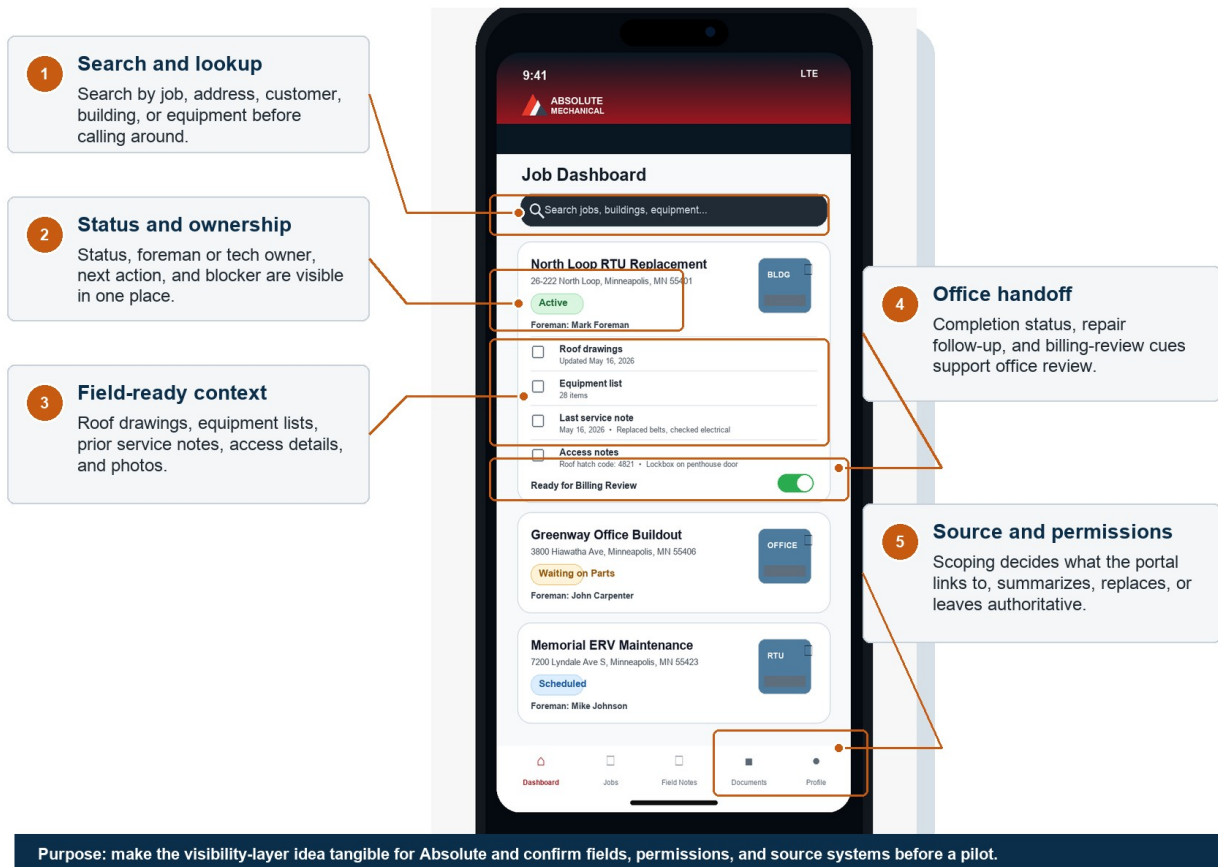
CONCEPT PREVIEW

Use the mobile portal diagram to test the visibility idea before scoping features.

The diagram below is not a product design. It is a practical prompt for the scoping conversation: what information should a field user, office user, project manager, or owner be able to see from one current operating view?

Diagram | Mobile Portal Features Reflected in the Mockup

Straight-on companion to the rooftop mockup; callouts translate discovery needs into fields to validate during scoping.



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WHAT THE FIELD OPERATIONS PORTAL WOULD DO

Create a current operating view without replacing every system first.

A first version does not need to replace TeamUp, Dropbox, QuickBooks, the server, Microsoft tools, paper files, or field judgment on day one. It could create a cleaner current view while also clarifying which paid apps might eventually be reduced, consolidated, linked, or left alone.

WHAT TO CALL THIS TYPE OF APP

Teams often call this kind of tool a field operations portal, work management dashboard, operational visibility layer, or single pane of glass. The common idea is the same: it does not own every record, but it gives the right people one current view of the work.

User group	What they should be able to see or do
Field installer / foreman	Pull up job context from a phone: address, contact, project manager, current drawings, roof access, lockbox notes, equipment list, photos, scope notes, and what needs to be completed.
Service technician	See building/equipment history, prior service notes, maintenance history, photos, open recommendations, parts quote needs, and required inspection/startup forms.
Office / service manager	See completion status, technician notes/photos, repair proposal needs, parts quote follow-up, preventive maintenance updates, and whether a job is ready for billing review.
Ownership	See active work, ownership, status, capacity signals, blockers, and whether relevant building/customer history already exists before someone starts from scratch.

ROLE AND UPDATE RULES

Scoping should validate the role map: ownership, project managers, office/service managers, foremen/installers, service technicians, accounting/bookkeeping, and external contacts such as GCs or vendors. For each field, decide who can view it, who can add or edit it, who approves it, and who owns keeping it current.

NOTE ON PARING DOWN APPS

The discovery raised the possibility of reducing some systems or subscriptions. That may be possible, but it should follow a source-of-truth review: what each app does today, what information people rely on, what the new portal would replace or merely link to, and what would create risk if removed too early.

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GENERATIVE AI ROLE

Use AI to shape the system first; use deeper sensemaking later.

Generative AI can be useful here as a way to interrogate data, documents, workflow, and tacit knowledge so a business can see useful patterns and use cases it might otherwise miss. In this case, the work begins by studying where information lives, what people repeatedly ask for, which decisions depend on memory, and how AI might help translate that understanding into better systems. Deeper analysis of historical bids, records, and buried data can follow once the operating view is clearer.

AI-assisted opportunity	How it could help	Guardrail
Bid invite extraction	Pull GC, GC project manager, job name, address, walkthrough date, and bid due date from emails for review.	Human review before action.
Technician notes to draft language	Turn field notes into cleaner customer-facing draft language for office review.	No automatic invoice/proposal sending.
Building/equipment history	Summarize approved records so field and office users see relevant context faster.	Only from approved sources.
Historical bid/job-cost analysis	Later, study job types, square footage, labor assumptions, equipment patterns, and profitability.	Sequence after records and permissions are clearer.

RECOMMENDED GUARDRAIL

A first phase should not expose QuickBooks Desktop, payroll, banking, margin, customer pricing, or sensitive financial information to AI. AI should assist approved workflows; it should not become the source of truth or automatically communicate with customers.

IMPLEMENTATION PATHS

Compare options briefly and practically.

Path	Where it may help	Caution / fit
Off-the-shelf contractor software	May offer dispatch, service history, work orders, forms, inventory, invoicing, and field workflows.	Worth a brief look; do not force construction into a rigid service-dispatch model.
Microsoft-based options	Microsoft 365 tools may support controlled records, permissions, lists, forms, and simple mobile workflows.	Current usage appears mostly desktop-based, so adoption and support need scoping.
Custom field operations portal	Could be tailored to Absolute's mix of construction, service, preventive maintenance, equipment history, and office review.	Requires disciplined scoping, cost, architecture, maintenance, security, and adoption planning.

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ONE POSSIBLE FIRST PILOT

Start small enough to learn, not small enough to be irrelevant.

This is one possible path, not a final recommendation. If the field-operations-portal concept feels right, the next step is a focused pilot that proves whether the idea is useful in real work before rolling anything out broadly.

Exhibit 3 | One Possible First Pilot Boundary

A small pilot can test usefulness before committing to a company-wide system or heavy AI effort.

Include in pilot

- 3-5 representative jobs or buildings
- Job, customer, site, field owner
- Status, next action, blocker
- Drawings, roof maps, equipment lists
- Controlled access notes
- Role-based permissions

Defer or restrict

- Deep QuickBooks integration
- Payroll, banking, margin, pricing
- AP / lien waiver automation
- Full TeamUp or Dropbox replacement
- Automatic customer invoices/proposals
- Broad historical AI analysis

Success question: can the right person see what is happening, what is next, who owns it, what is blocked, and where the current context lives without calling around?

WHAT SCOPING MUST ANSWER

Before any commitment, the next conversation should clarify what the pilot would look like, what it might cost, who maintains it, how permissions and sensitive information are handled, what stays authoritative in TeamUp, Dropbox, QuickBooks, Microsoft, server folders, or paper, and what adoption rules would need to change.

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RECOMMENDED NEXT STEP

Use the next call to pressure-test scope, cost, and adoption.

The goal of the next conversation is not to jump straight into a build. It is to decide whether this field-operations-portal concept is right and what a first pilot would actually require.

SUGGESTED NEXT CONVERSATION

If this framing feels accurate, the suggested next step is a scoping call with Nick Lipetsky, an AI Systems Architect. Nick would be useful at this stage because the next questions are technical and operational architecture questions: what a visibility-layer pilot would require, what it might cost, what should stay out of scope, how security and permissions should work, and whether a custom build, Microsoft-based approach, off-the-shelf option, or hybrid path makes the most sense. He has built bespoke digital platforms and helped build companies from the ground up, which would make him a strong steward regardless of which path Absolute ultimately chooses. The purpose would not be to jump straight into a build; it would be to pressure-test the path before any commitment.

Output from scoping	Why it matters
Scoping output	Clarifies target workflow, sample jobs/buildings, required fields, source systems, permission model, likely build path, rough cost range, and operational ownership.
Scope boundary	Clarifies what stays out of phase one, especially QuickBooks, payroll, banking, margin, customer pricing, and broad AI analysis.
Adoption plan	Explains what the tool is for, who updates it, what old behavior it replaces, and how the team will be supported in using it.

CHANGE-MANAGEMENT NOTE

The change-management piece matters for any process change. Otherwise, the tools a company invests in can sit idle or be used at far less than their maximum value. Any pilot should explain what the tool is for, how it helps, what it replaces, who is responsible for keeping it current, and how the team will know whether it is working.

ADDENDUM A: SUPPORTING NOTES / DISCOVERY SYNTHESIS

A supporting memo is included separately for additional discovery context. It is not a second brief; it preserves the logic behind the recommendation so the main brief can stay focused on the practical next step: scope the field operations portal first, then choose the right path.